

Packet Tracer – Hostname and Password Configuration

Objectives

Part 1: Build a Basic Network Topology

Part 2: Configure Device Hostnames

Part 3: Configure Console and Enable Passwords

Part 4: Verify Login Security

Background / Scenario

As a network administrator, one of your first tasks when deploying a new switch or router is to assign a meaningful hostname and secure the device from unauthorized access.

In this lab, you will configure a switch with a custom hostname, set a console password for local access, and configure an enable password to protect privileged EXEC mode.

This lab focuses on:

- Understanding the purpose of device hostnames
- Securing console access
- Protecting privileged EXEC mode
- Navigating between User EXEC and Privileged EXEC modes

You are building a strong foundation for future CCNA configuration and security labs.

Instructions

Part 1: Build the Network Topology

Step 1: Add the Devices

- Open **Cisco Packet Tracer**.
- From **Network Devices** → **Switches**, drag a **2960 Switch** onto the workspace.
- From **End Devices**, drag a **PC** onto the workspace.
- Rename the PC:

- PC0 → **Admin-PC**
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Step 2: Connect the Devices

Since a PC is connecting to a switch, you will use a **Copper Straight-Through** cable.

- a. Click **Connections** (lightning bolt icon).
- b. Select **Copper Straight-Through**.
- c. Connect **Admin-PC** → **FastEthernet0**.
- d. Connect **Switch** → **FastEthernet0/1**.

Wait a few seconds until the link lights turn **green**.

Your physical topology is now complete.

Part 2: Configure the Device Hostname

Step 1: Access the Switch CLI

- a. Click the **Switch**.
- b. Select the **CLI** tab.
- c. Press **Enter** when prompted.

You should see:

```
Switch>
```

Step 2: Enter Privileged EXEC Mode

Type:

```
enable
```

The prompt changes to:

```
Switch#
```

Step 3: Enter Global Configuration Mode

Type:

configure terminal

The prompt changes to:

Switch(config)#

Step 4: Configure the Hostname

Type:

hostname S1

The prompt should now display:

S1(config)#

This confirms that the hostname has been successfully changed.

Part 3: Configure Console and Enable Passwords

Step 1: Configure the Console Password

From Global Configuration Mode, type:

line console 0

password cisco

login

exit

Command Explanation:

- **line console 0** — Accesses the console line configuration.
 - **password cisco** — Sets the console password.
 - **login** — Requires password authentication.
 - **exit** — Returns to Global Configuration Mode.
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Step 2: Configure the Enable Password

From Global Configuration Mode, type:

enable password class

This password will be required whenever someone enters Privileged EXEC mode using the **enable** command.

Step 3: Save the Configuration

Type:

```
end  
write memory
```

Expected output:

```
Building configuration...  
[OK]
```

Why Save the Configuration?

By default, all configuration changes are stored only in the device's **Running Configuration (RAM)**.

The command:

```
write memory
```

copies the Running Configuration into the **Startup Configuration (NVRAM)**.

Without saving, all changes will be lost if the device is restarted or powered off.

Part 4: Verify Login Security

Step 1: Exit to the Login Screen

Type:

```
exit
```

until you reach:

```
S1>
```

Close and reopen the CLI window if necessary.

Step 2: Test the Console Password

You should see:

User Access Verification

Password:

Enter:

cisco

You should now gain access to User EXEC mode:

S1>

Step 3: Test the Enable Password

Type:

enable

You will be prompted for a password:

Password:

Enter:

class

The prompt should change to:

S1#

This confirms that the enable password is working correctly.

Troubleshooting Tips

If you cannot log in:

✓ Verify you entered **login** under the console line configuration.

✓ Make sure the console password is spelled correctly.

- ✓ Confirm you configured the enable password before testing.
 - ✓ If you forgot to save, reconfigure the device after restarting.
 - ✓ Check that the prompt changes from **Switch** to **S1** after configuring the hostname.
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What You Learned

- How to configure a device hostname
 - The difference between User EXEC and Privileged EXEC modes
 - How to secure console access with a password
 - How to protect Privileged EXEC mode using an enable password
 - The purpose of the **write memory** command
 - The difference between Running Configuration and Startup Configuration
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Challenge Extensions (Optional)

Try modifying the lab:

1. Change the hostname from **S1** to **Branch-SW1**.
2. Change the console password from **cisco** to **admin123**.
3. Configure an **enable secret** instead of an **enable password**.

enable secret class123

- Which one is more secure?
 - Why does Cisco recommend using enable secret?
4. Add a router and configure its hostname and passwords using the same commands.